

The Blue Door

Book 1 of 10

A story about a new beginning - and a door with a secret.

CEFR Level A1 | Adult Graded Reader

Setting: A small coastal town in England. Sara's new café near the sea.

Genre: Mystery / Warm Drama

Characters

- Sara - 32. Café owner. Quiet and curious. New in town.
- Tom - 60. Fisherman. Friendly. Comes every morning.
- Mrs. Ellis - 75. Retired teacher. Knows the history of the town.
- Alice - The woman from the past. An artist.

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Sara opens the door. The café is small and quiet. There is one big window. The light comes in from the sea. There are five tables and twelve chairs. The walls are white. There is a counter near the door. Sara looks around. She smiles. This is her café now. This is her new life. Then she sees it. At the back of the room - there is a door. It is blue. The paint is old.

Sara walks to the blue door. She puts her hand on it. The wood is cold. She tries to open it. It does not open. It is locked. Sara looks for a key everywhere - on the counter, in the kitchen, in the small office. There is no key. Sara does not understand. Why is this door locked? What is behind it?

The café is open. A man walks in. He is tall and old, with white hair and a big coat. He smells of the sea. "Good morning. I am Tom. I come here every day." "Good morning. I am Sara. What do you want?" "Coffee, please. Black. No sugar." Tom sits at the table near the window and looks at the sea.

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Sara notices the old blue door at the back of the café.

Sara brings Tom his coffee. He drinks slowly. "Tom, do you know that door? The blue one at the back?" Tom puts down his cup. He looks at the window. "It is just a door. An old door." "But it is locked," Sara says. "There is no key." Tom stands up. "More coffee?" He changes the subject.

An old woman comes into the café. She has grey hair and kind eyes. "Hello. I am Mrs. Ellis. I live near here. I know this café very well." Mrs. Ellis sits at the table near the window. She looks around the room. Her eyes stop at the blue door. She smiles - a small, quiet smile. "Tea, please. With milk."

"Mrs. Ellis, do you know the blue door at the back?" Mrs. Ellis is quiet for a moment. "Yes. I know it." "What is behind it?" "It is a good story. But not today. Come and see me on Friday - number four, Sea Road." She drinks her tea and says nothing more.

Sara is alone in the café. It is evening. She cleans the counter and looks under it. There is something on the floor, in the corner. It is a small wooden box - dark brown and very dusty. Sara takes it out and puts it on the counter. There is no name on it. No label. "What is this?" she says to

herself.

Sara opens the box. Inside, there are three things. First: two old black-and-white photographs of a young woman standing in front of the café. Second: a short letter on yellow, old paper. Third: a small metal key. Sara picks up the key. It is cold and heavy. She looks at the blue door. Then at the key. Then at the door again.

Sara reads the letter. The words are simple. "For the next person who has this café. This key opens the blue door. Behind the door, there is a small room. The room belongs to Alice. Open it when you are ready. Take care of it. Take care of the café. With love." There is no name. No date. "Alice," Sara says quietly. "Who is Alice?"

The next morning, Sara puts the key next to Tom's coffee. Tom looks at it. His face goes white. "Where did you find this?" His voice is very quiet. "Under the counter. In a box with photos and a letter." Tom holds the key for a long time. "You know Alice," Sara says. Tom nods. "Yes. She was my friend."

"Alice had this café for twenty years," Tom says. "She was good. Quiet. Kind. She loved the

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Sara finds an old box with photographs, a letter, and a key.

sea." "What is in the room?" Sara asks. "Her things. Books. Paintings. She made a small studio there. She was an artist." "Why did she leave?" "Her mother was ill. Alice went to help her." Tom looks at the door. "She said: one day, the right person will open it."

Sara walks to Sea Road. Number four is a small house with red flowers. Mrs. Ellis opens the door before Sara knocks. 'Come in.' The house is warm and full of books. There are photos on the walls. One photo stops Sara: a young woman in front of the café. "That is Alice," Sara says. "Yes," Mrs. Ellis says. "Sit down. I will tell you everything."

"Alice came here thirty years ago. She was alone. She bought the café with all her money." "We were very good friends. She painted every day in that little room." "Why did she leave?" "Her mother was ill. She went to help. She said: I will come back. But she did not." "Is she dead?" "No," Mrs. Ellis says quickly. "She writes to me. She lives in the north. She is old but well."

"Does Alice know I have the café?" Sara asks. "Yes. I wrote to her. I told her about you." "What did she say?" Mrs. Ellis smiles. "She said: I hope she opens the door." "I want to open it," Sara says.

"But I want to write to Alice first." "Good," Mrs. Ellis says. "I think Alice will like that very much."

Sara sits at the counter with a pen and paper. She writes slowly. "Dear Alice. My name is Sara. I have your café now. I love it. I found the box, the key, your letter. I want to open the blue door - but I want to ask you first. Is it all right? I will take care of the café. I promise. With respect, Sara." She folds the letter, puts it in an envelope, and writes the address Mrs. Ellis gave her.

Two weeks pass. Tom comes every morning. Mrs. Ellis comes on Tuesdays and Fridays. Every day Sara looks at the blue door. Every day she waits. Then on a Tuesday morning, Mrs. Ellis comes in with a letter. "This is for you," she says. Sara opens the envelope carefully. Inside: one piece of paper. The writing is thin but clear.

"Dear Sara. Thank you for your letter. It made me very happy. Yes. Please open the door. I painted in that room for twenty years. I left my brushes, my paints, my last unfinished painting - a picture of the sea. I always wanted the right person to find it. I think you are the right person. Take care of my sea. With love, Alice." Sara reads it three times, then puts it in the box next to the

old photos.

Saturday morning. Sara is alone. She stands in front of the blue door. The key is in her hand. She puts the key in the lock. She turns it slowly. Click. The door opens. The room is small and dark. Sara finds the light switch. She stops. There are shelves with old books, tins of paint, brushes in a jar. On the wall: one large painting of the sea. Half finished. The colours are deep and quiet.

Sara sits on the floor in front of the painting for a long time. The sea is the same sea outside the café window. The same colour. The same light. Tom comes in. He walks to the room and looks at the painting. "She always painted the sea," he says. His voice is soft. "It is not finished," Sara says. Tom looks at her. "No. But maybe that is all right." Sara nods.

Sara does not change the room. She cleans it gently and puts Alice's brushes back on the shelf. She writes to Alice again. I opened the door. The room is beautiful. The painting is beautiful. I will not change anything. The room is yours - it will always be yours. But I want a small table and chair inside. A place to sit and look at the sea. With love, Sara. Tom drinks his coffee. Mrs. Ellis has her tea.

The blue door is open. Outside, the sea is quiet and grey and beautiful. Some things take a long time. But they are worth the wait.

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Sara opens the blue door and discovers Alice's seaside studio.

Story Vocabulary

The words below are collected from the story. They are given together so the reading pages stay like a real story book.

1. café	kafe	2. quiet	sessiz
3. counter	tezgâh	4. wall	duvar
5. back	arka taraf	6. locked	kilitli
7. key	anahtar	8. wood	tahta
9. tries	dener	10. behind	arkasında
11. tall	uzun boylu	12. coat	palto
13. sugar	şeker	14. every day	her gün
15. smells of	kokusu var	16. slowly	yavaşça
17. just	sadece	18. stands up	ayağa kalkar
19. changes the subject	konuyu değiştirir	20. grey hair	gri saç
21. kind	nazik	22. afternoon	öğleden sonra
23. stops at	... de durur	24. milk	süt
25. moment	an	26. looks up	başını kaldırır
27. story	hikâye	28. Sea Road	Deniz Caddesi
29. alone	yalnız	30. floor	zemin
31. corner	köşe	32. dusty	tozlu
33. wooden	ahşap	34. photographs	fotoğraflar
35. black and white	siyah beyaz	36. letter	mektup
37. metal	metal	38. heavy	ağır
39. belongs to	... ait	40. take care of	... ile ilgilenmek

41. with love	sevgiyle	42. date	tarih
43. ready	hazır	44. goes white	solar
45. voice	ses	46. holds	tutar
47. nods	başını sallar	48. was	idi
49. had	sahipti	50. paintings	tablolar
51. studio	atölye	52. artist	sanatçı
53. ill	hasta	54. right person	doğru kişi
55. knocks	kapıyı çalar	56. warm	sıcak
57. full of	... ile dolu	58. everything	her şey
59. bought	satın aldı	60. did not come back	geri dönmedi
61. north	kuzey	62. well	sağlıklı
63. wrote	yazdı	64. told	anlattı
65. hope	ummak	66. first	önce
67. dear	sayın, sevgili	68. promise	söz vermek
69. respect	saygı	70. envelope	zarf
71. folds	katlar	72. pass	geçmek (zaman)
73. waits	bekler	74. carefully	dikkatle
75. thin	ince	76. clear	açık, net
77. made me happy	beni mutlu etti	78. brushes	fırçalar
79. unfinished	yarım kalmış	80. always	her zaman
81. lock	kilit	82. click	tıklama sesi
83. shelves	raflar	84. tins	kutular
85. half finished	yarım kalmış	86. deep	derin, koyu
87. same	aynı	88. outside	dışarıda

89. lets him in	içeri alır	90. soft	kısıık, yumuşak
91. maybe	belki	92. gently	nazıkçe
93. will always be	her zaman olacak	94. worth the wait	beklemeye değer

After-Reading Activities

1. Vocabulary Practice - Match the Words

Match each word with the correct meaning.

1. locked

A. söz vermek

2. key

B. kilitli

3. dusty

C. anahtar

4. unfinished

D. tozlu

5. promise

E. yarım kalmış

6. envelope

F. zarf

7. gently

G. nazikçe

8. shelves

H. raflar

2. Fill in the Blanks

Choose the correct word from the box and write it in the blank.

locked - dusty - shelves - soft - unfinished - carefully

1. The blue door is _____. Sara does not have a key.

2. The box under the counter is old and _____.

3. Tom's voice is _____ when he talks about Alice.

4. There are _____ with old books in the room.

5. Alice left an _____ painting of the sea.

6. Sara opens the envelope _____.

3. Comprehension Questions

True or False? Write T or F.

1. Sara has the café for ten years. ____
2. Tom comes to the café every morning. ____
3. Mrs. Ellis lives on Sea Road. ____
4. The box is on top of the counter. ____
5. Alice is dead. ____
6. Alice was an artist. ____

Short Answer Questions

7. What colour is the door at the back of the café?
8. What are the three things inside the box?
9. Who is Alice?
10. Where does Alice live now?
11. What is in the room behind the door?
12. What does the painting show?
13. What does Sara write in her letter to Alice?
14. Does Alice say yes or no?
15. What does Sara do with the room at the end?

Answer Key

(Alıştırmaları yaptıktan sonra bakınız.)

Match: 1-B 2-C 3-D 4-E 5-A 6-F 7-G 8-H

Fill in the Blanks: 1. locked 2. dusty 3. soft 4. shelves 5. unfinished
6. carefully

True / False: 1. F 2. T 3. T 4. F 5. F 6. T

7. Blue.

8. Two old photographs, a short letter, and a small metal key.

9. The previous owner of the café. An artist.

10. In the north.

11. Old books, tins of paint, brushes, and an unfinished painting of the sea.

12. The sea.

13. She asks if it is all right to open the door.

14. Yes.

15. She cleans it gently and does not change anything.